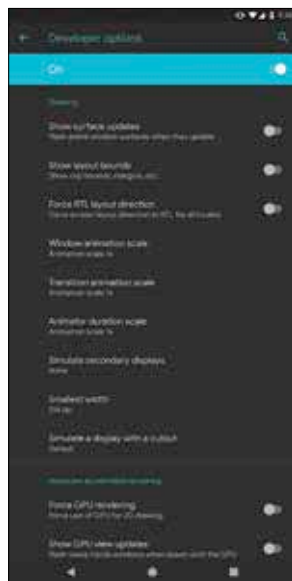


animation varies in different phones and some launchers allow you to choose your desired animation. If your phone has low system memory then after a few years of OS updates, it becomes sluggish. Or you might simply hate waiting for the microseconds of the animations. Whatever the case, you can



reduce the duration of these animations or completely disable them. For this, you'll need to have Developer Options enabled. Inside Developer Options, scroll down to Drawing and you'll come across Window animation scale, Transition animation scale and Animator duration scale. These control the duration of the different components of the System UI transitions. Usually set at 1x, you can bring them down to 0.5x or turn them off. If you're feeling crazy then you can also bump it up to 10x and enjoy the smooth but prolonged transitions throughout the system.

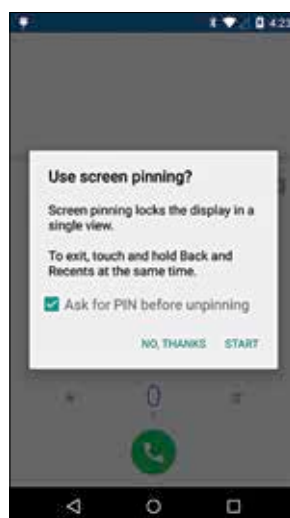
08 Check notifications that have already been swiped away

Notifications can be as helpful as they are irritating. Way too many notifications can clutter up the lockscreen. Out of habit, a lot of us tend to swipe notifications away, only to realise that they might have been important. Even if that is not the case with you, you might want to keep track of how frequently an app has sent you notifications, or how frequently a particular contact has messaged you or called you. To do all

of this, there's a pretty simple method that does not require any third party tool. However, it does require your Android phone to support widgets as well as have a particular standard widget that will let this feature work. On your home screen, long press any blank space or use a two finger pinch to bring up the customisation menu, which should have an option to add widgets. Select that, and you should be on the widget selection menu. On this menu, scroll down until you find the Settings shortcut widget. Drag and place it where you would want it to be on your home screen. Then, in the menu that opens when you place it, select notification log. Now, when you tap on this shortcut you should be able to see a list of notifications that showed up on your lockscreen or notification shade in chronological order. Please note that you need to close any open instances of the settings menu itself for this to work. Also, if you've set your notifications to hide their contents, they'll be hidden here as well. *Pro Tip: This can be used to read deleted WhatsApp messages as well.*

09 Keep other apps private

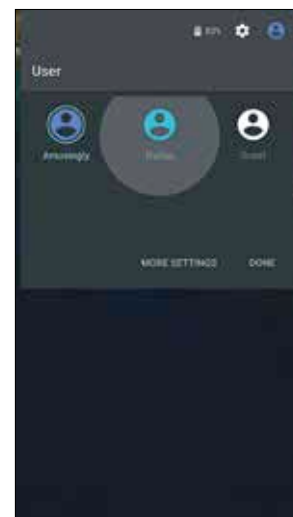
How many times has it happened that your friend or even your parents, have asked for your phone for some genuinely harmless reason and yet your heart has skipped a beat? What if they switch to your IM app and check your chats? What about the gallery where you hold memes too dank for mere mortals to comprehend? Rather than drowning in anxiety when this



happens, use a simple trick provided by Android to lock them into the particular app they intend to use. Found under Security in some phones and under Privacy in some phones, you need to look for Screen Pinning under some sub-menu in Settings. Turn that on and then head back to the Recent app screen. You should see a Pin icon over the image of the last active app. Hit that and the particular app should be locked on to the screen. The instruction to exit the locked mode is usually displayed for a couple of seconds before it disappears. Once that happens, your phone is temporarily safe from prying eyes.

10 Use Guest account

The reason we used the word 'temporarily' in the last tip is that Screen Pinning may not be the best idea for someone who borrows your phone frequently and for extended



durations. Some phones also do not provide a security measure to pinned screens, so someone fiddling around for long enough might be able to figure out the button combination required to exit a pinned screen. In such a situation, another Android feature comes to use - Guest Mode. Available since Android 5.0, the Guest Mode is a useful tool to let a guest access all features of your device without risking your private data. It's like handing over a factory reset phone to someone. While there are multiple ways in which different phone manufacturers handle this, the stock Android method is fairly instructive. Go to **Settings > Users and accounts > Users > Guest** to add a